Charcuterie Lab

FREE PRINTABLE

The Pairing Cheat Sheet

What to put out with the wine or beer you're pouring. Best matches first.

Pinot Noir

Serve 55–60°F, slightly cool

Gruyère · Comté · Aged Gouda · Brie · Taleggio

Why the first one works: Nutty, sweet-savory crystals meet Pinot's red cherry and earth. The classic.

Cabernet Sauvignon

Serve 60–65°F

Aged Cheddar · Aged Gouda · Parmigiano-Reggiano · Manchego · Mimolette

Why the first one works: Sharp, crumbly cheddar softens tannin and stands up to blackcurrant fruit.

Champagne & Prosecco

Serve 42–46°F, well chilled

Triple-Crème · Brie · Parmigiano-Reggiano · Comté · Gougères

Why the first one works: Pure butterfat, lifted by bubbles. The best pairing in this hub.

Sauvignon Blanc

Serve 45–50°F

Fresh Chèvre · Crottin de Chavignol · Sainte-Maure de Touraine · Feta · Whipped Feta

Why the first one works: Tang meets tang; acid on acid makes both taste creamier.

Chardonnay

Serve 50–55°F

Brie · Camembert · Gruyère · Comté · Aged Cheddar

Why the first one works: Butter meets butter. Oaked Chardonnay is brie's natural partner.

Rosé

Serve 45–50°F

Feta · Fresh Chèvre · Manchego · Burrata · Prosciutto di Parma

Why the first one works: Salty and tangy with a crisp, fruity pink.

Riesling

Serve 45–50°F

Muenster · Taleggio · Époisses · Limburger · Smoked Gouda

Why the first one works: Alsace's washed-rind cheese with Alsace's grape.

Merlot

Serve 60–65°F

Aged Gouda · Aged Cheddar · Gruyère · Havarti · Fontina

Why the first one works: Caramel and plum: a warm, round pairing.

Malbec

Serve 60–65°F

Smoked Gouda · Aged Cheddar · Manchego · Chorizo · Soppressata

Why the first one works: Smoke meets dark fruit and cocoa.

Charcuterie Lab

FREE PRINTABLE

The Pairing Cheat Sheet

What to put out with the wine or beer you're pouring. Best matches first.

Chianti & Sangiovese

Serve 60–65°F

Pecorino Toscano · Parmigiano-Reggiano · Pecorino Romano · Finocchiona · Prosciutto di Parma

Why the first one works: Tuscan sheep's cheese with a Tuscan red.

Port

Serve 60–65°F (tawny slightly cooler)

Stilton · Roquefort · Gorgonzola · Cabrales · Aged Cheddar

Why the first one works: The most famous cheese-and-wine pairing in Britain.

Beaujolais

Serve 55°F, lightly chilled

Pâté de Campagne · Saucisson Sec · Rosette de Lyon · Comté · Brie

Why the first one works: The Lyon bistro pairing.

IPA

Serve 45–50°F

Aged Cheddar · Pepper Jack · Gorgonzola · Maytag Blue · Soppressata

Why the first one works: Sharp cheddar and hops: the best-known beer-cheese pairing.

Lager & Pilsner

Serve 38–45°F

Havarti · Emmental · Gruyère · Muenster · Landjäger

Why the first one works: Mild and buttery with a clean, crisp beer.

Stout & Porter

Serve 50–55°F

Aged Cheddar · Smoked Gouda · Stilton · Gorgonzola · Aged Gouda

Why the first one works: Irish cheddar and Irish stout: sharp against roast.

Wheat Beer

Serve 40–45°F

Fresh Chèvre · Feta · Havarti · Burrata · Smoked Salmon

Why the first one works: Tangy goat cheese and citrusy witbier.

Belgian Ale

Serve 45–50°F

Port Salut · Taleggio · Époisses · Reblochon · Aged Gouda

Why the first one works: Monastery-style cheese with monastery-style beer.

Hard Cider

Serve 40–45°F

Aged Cheddar · Camembert · Brie · Gruyère · Red Leicester

Why the first one works: Apple and cheddar in a glass. English farmhouse classic.